

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
No.31. 29th of July 2024



'FOCUS ON YOUR DESTINY NOT ON YOUR HISTORY'



- HOW MUCH TIME DO WE GIVE DWELLING ON **OUR HISTORY** COMPARED WITH THE TIME WE DWELL ON OUR DESTINY'?
- * When we spend a disproportionate amount of time and energy thinking about **our history** / our past journey - compared with the time and energy we give to our destiny - then it weakens the degree of our motivation.
- * In dwelling on **our history** – our past journey we energise it so that tends to dominate our thought life.
- * Why not give thought to our destiny and those future things that God pre-arranged, planned and commissioned us to do.
- **BY DWELLING ON OUR DESTINY, WE GIVE POWER AND PASSION TO IT.**
- **THOSE THINGS THAT GOD HAS PROMISED US ARE PART OF OUR DESTINY – OUR FUTURE.**
- When we constantly dwell on the past (**our history**) we feed and give power to those things that includes our regrets, failures, mistakes, those sorrowful unwise decisions and dreams that never eventuated along with our victories, advancements, and successes.
- * Successes can imprison us as much as our failures!

OUR HISTORY

- * We can often spend too much time reflecting on the DIFFICULTIES, the UNKNOWNs of our past journey which at times have caused us to question, complain and even be critical of others.
- * Why is it that we find it difficult to leave the unanswered questions in the hands of a loving heavenly Father for him to address them in his time and we move on towards the things that pertain to our destiny, those that we are called to do?

OUR HISTORY.

Questions do arise

- * We question why this and why that and conclude that life is not fair?
- * We dwell on past failures, past offences and hurts, or opportunities that we missed.
- * We are continually thinking and wishing that we had made a different choice of vocation or location etc.
- * Some people remain regretful because that they have wrongly missed out on opportunities of recognition and advancement that they believed they were entitled to.
- * Then there are those who through past failure and have 'messed up' and the remorse and disappointment can't seem to get beyond those things, so that they remain stuck **in the history of the past.**

- * Such persons are missing the glorious things that **are ahead of us in God which are a part of our destiny.**
- * Going back over the **why's and wherefores of the past** only gives unnecessary encouragement and strength **to our history** and energises those past events so that it paralyses and imprisons us from moving on into **the future opportunities** prepared for us.
- * **YES**, we are called to remember the past events and to learn from them **BUT NOT** to remain there - living in **"memory lane"**.
- * **Living in the memory of past events**, good or otherwise does nothing to stimulate us to **MOVE ON** to what God has in store for us to accomplish.
- **IN FACT, IT TENDS TO INCAPACITATE AND EMBOLDEN US TO DWELL IN THE SECURITY AND SAFETY OF THE PAST.**

OUR DESTINY

THOSE THINGS AHEAD OF US

- **WHEN WE GIVE CONSTANT THOUGHT, REFLECTION, and MEDITATION to that which is AHEAD of us TO THOSE THINGS THAT GOD PRE ARRANGED OF US TO DO.**

Ephesians 2:10 For we are God's [own] handiwork (His workmanship), recreated in Christ Jesus, [born anew] that we may do those good works which God predestined (planned beforehand) for us [taking paths which He prepared ahead of time], that we should walk in them [living the good life which He prearranged and made ready for us to live]. AMP)

Ephesians 2:10 For we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance for us to do. NIV

- **When we think and speak of those FUTURE things that God has planned for us, we give energy, power, credibility and endorsement to those things which are part of OUR DESTINY / CALLING.**

- **LET US BE PASSIONATE, PURPOSEFUL AND PERSISTENT IN PURSUING THOSE PATHWAYS OF GOOD WORKS THAT GOD HAS BEFORE ORDAINED THAT WE SHOULD WALK IN THEM.**

- **WALKING IN THE WAYS OF THE GOOD WORKS OF GOD THAT WE ARE ANOINTED TO DO.**

John 14:12 I tell you the truth, whoever believes in me will do the same things that I do. Those who believe will do even greater things than these, because I am going to the Father. NCV

Acts 10:38 How God anointed Jesus of Nazareth with the Holy Ghost and with power: who went about doing good, and healing all that were oppressed of the devil; for God was with him. KJV

- **And into this picture of our history and destiny comes OUR ACCOMPLISHMENTS AND OPPORTUNITIES.**

- **WE SHOULD NOT BE MAJORING ON OUR ACCOMPLISHMENTS, BUT ON OUR OPPORTUNITIES.**

- **It is so easy to get caught up in centring our attention on what we have accomplished and completely miss SEEING THOSE AMAZING THINGS THAT GOD HAS PREPARED FOR US yet TO DO.**

- * **And what an exciting adventure it is discovering and engaging ourselves in those things.**

HISTORY OR DESTINY?

- **OUR ACCOMPLISHMENTS ARE IN THE PAST, (WHICH IS PART OF OUR HISTORY – BUT OUR OPPORTUNITIES ARE IN THE FUTURE – AND THEY ARE PART OF OUR DESTINY.**

- **MAY EACH ONE OF US BE ENCOURAGED TO USE ALL OUR ENERGY AND EFFORTS IN PURSUING OUR GOD ORDAINED DESTINY WHICH IS INSEPARABLY CONNECTED WITH THOSE GOOD WORKS THAT GOD HAS BEFOREHAND PREPARED FOR US TO WALK IN.**

- **AND FOR THE PLACES HE WANTS US TO GO AND FOR THOSE PRECIOUS PERSONS WHOM WE MAY ENCOUNTER WHO ARE IN DESPERATE NEED OF GOD'S HELP.**

Amen – Ps Barry